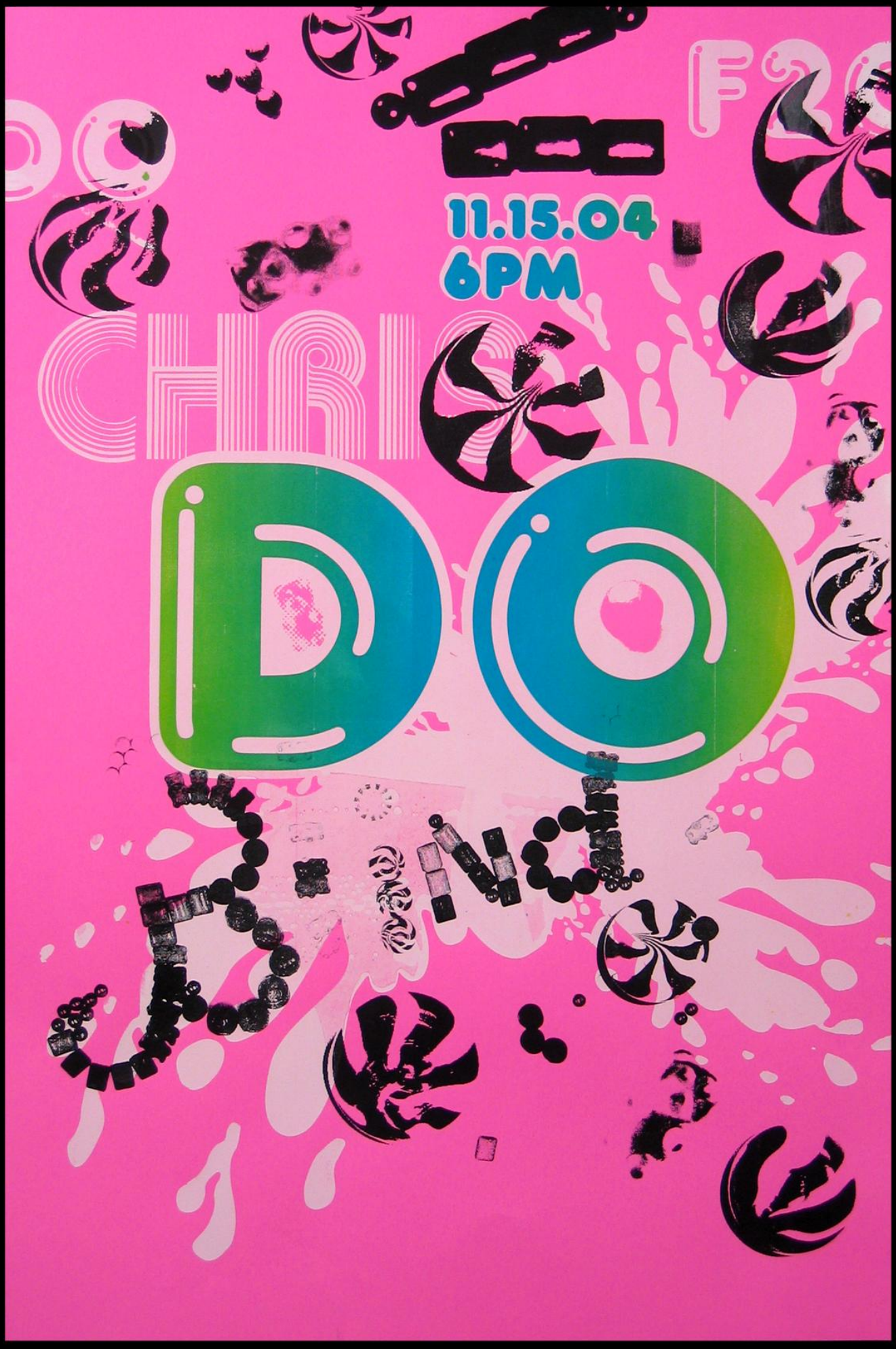
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Which term(s) best describe the function or purpose of the poster? There can be more than 1 right answer.

- [ ] Networking

- [x] Commentary on the practice of motion graphics

> ✓ **Correct**
> The visual pun and metaphor of "eye candy" refers to the sweet, exciting and pleasurable — but sometimes insubstantial — experience of viewing motion graphics. The commentary is both a critique and celebration of the formally exuberant medium of motion graphics.

- [x] Promotion / advertising

> ✓ **Correct**
> The poster uses bright, large-scale graphic form to attract attention and present information about Chris Do's lecture. The graphic form is meant to relate to the lecture and create interest in the lecture's content.

- [ ] Wayfinding

2. Which of the following terms best describes how the visual language "pop vernacular" is used in the poster seen in the previous question (#1)?

- (●) Reference (the poster uses elements of the visual language in a new context)
- ( ) Imitation (the poster is meant to look like a genuine artifact of the visual language)

✓ **Correct**

The poster uses elements of pop vernacular such as display (novelty) typefaces, graphic effects (extrusion, gradient) and bright color in the context of a visiting artist lecture. The lecture is a new context because it is an event at an art school (high/niche culture) and is not directly associated with commerce or advertising (low/mainstream culture).

Which of the following visual languages do you see used or referenced in this work?

- ○ **8-bit / Internet 1.0**: The visual language 8-bit / Internet 1.0 is based on the aesthetics of the early Internet and video games. This style came from the low-resolution imagery that was the result of the processing, storage and data transfer limitations of the time.
- ○ **Pop Art:** Pop Art uses the popular / mass culture (or vernacular) as its subject matter, and the visual language is generally driven by the use of found, appropriated imagery, with minimal abstraction, processing or interpretation.
- ○ **Minimalism**: The visual language of minimalism generally involves abstraction or is non-pictorial. It also tends to feature repetition or minimal, subtle variation.
- ◉ **Vernacular / Pop culture display**: A visual language characterized by a bright color palette, display novelty typefaces and bold graphic forms that are drawn from the aesthetics of mass market / popular culture advertising and signage.
- ○ **None of the above**

✓ **Correct**

The imagery in this poster is drawn from the visual language of advertising and signage. It is bold and colorful, and the choice of typefaces is based on visual impact, rather than on content or meaning.

4. Which of the following best describes the meaning created by the imagery (what is represented) and the visual language of the poster seen in the previous question (#3)?

- ○ Chris Do is a sweet person
- ◉ Motion graphics are “eye candy”: pleasurable, seductive and stimulating but also ephemeral and not substantive
- ○ Blind does promotional work for candy companies

✓ **Correct**

The candy is used metaphorically to communicate the idea of sweetness, immediate gratification, indulgence, and lack of substance typically associated with motion graphics.

Which phrase best describes the intended audience?

- (●) Students in an art and design college
- ( ) Parents of art and design students
- ( ) People over 60
- ( ) People with children

✓ **Correct**

The poster was hung on campus and intended to reach an audience of CalArts students.

6. Does the visual language of the poster shown in the previous question (#5) seem appropriate for the intended audience?

- (●) Yes, the use of pop culture and low-brow references plus the commentary on the practice of motion graphics is appropriate for an art school audience.
- ( ) No, the visual language seems nostalgic and dated.
- ( ) No, this is more appropriate for a candy shop.
- ( ) Yes, design students eat a lot of candy and the imagery would attract their attention.
- ( ) Yes, the colors and shapes would definitely appeal to teenagers.

✓ **Correct**

As art and design students, the audience is visually literate and would be able to interpret the multiple levels of meaning in the candy metaphor. This awareness of visual metaphor, visual literacy and cultural literacy is characteristic of a design school audience, as compared to the general public.

Which term best describes how the work is distributed to an audience?

- ○ Meme
- ○ Viral
- ○ Peer-to-peer
- ◉ Centralized or top-down

✓ **Correct**

The poster was hung on campus, presumably by a single group, office or individual. It was not freely distributed or circulated peer-to-peer.

8. Art schools are elite educational institutions. Why would a designer at an art school appropriate "low" cultural references?

- ○ High, middle, and low are socially constructed categories that have no meaning.
- ○ The designer has run out of ideas and is desperate.
- ○ The designer is attempting to hide their elite education by using a visual language that is "hip" and "street."
- ○ Designers follow fashion and fads, low-brow is the latest fad.
- ◉ Designers often demonstrate their sophistication and skill by reproducing visual idioms (familiar modes of expression) in new and unexpected contexts.

✓ **Correct**

The designer is offering the viewer an opportunity to engage with a work that is layered with meaning created by presenting familiar visual idioms and tropes (motifs / themes) in a new context.

9. **How successfully do you think the Chris Do poster does its job?** Write at least 1-2 sentences per response to the questions below using the Critique Framework.

1. Does the form seem appropriate to the subject matter and the intended audience?
2. Does the poster communicate the concept clearly?
3. Is the poster visually interesting?

Critique Framework v3.pdf
PDF File

1. Yes, seems appropriate for young design students
2. No, it's difficult to read. At first, I didn't even think it was an advertisement.
3. Yes, a lot of things going on but they are displayed in an interesting composition

✓ **Correct**

How does your response compare to the following analyses for each question?

1. The form in the poster (imagery and how it is graphically represented, color, type) addresses its intended audience of CalArts students and faculty effectively. The poster is bright, colorful, and a bit formally challenging. The colors and forms are a little too loud and acid-toned to be called "pretty" or "balanced". The challenging formal / color palette and metaphorical use of imagery are forms of communication appropriate for an audience of art and design students.
2. The poster clearly communicates the concept that motion graphics are indulgent, seductive, "sweet", but unsubstantial—almost a guilty pleasure—through metaphorical use of candy imagery. This concept is communicated clearly through use of imagery, typography, and content.
3. The poster's loud color palette, active composition and cheeky tone may not be to everyone's taste, but the poster is interesting to look at. Whether or not it is to your taste, we can see that the elements of visual contrast seem controlled, relevant to the content, and create visual interest. The use of visual metaphor to create meaning and commentary combined with multiple levels of detail in the form and composition help to sustain the viewer's engagement. Overall, we can say that it fulfills its primary functions of promoting a visiting artist lecture to a specific audience (the CalArts community), communicates an idea about the lecture, and is visually interesting.